English and in major Indian languages became increasingly available to the reading public. Indians also began writing about their own history, social practices and religions, and articulating their political opinions in newspapers and journals. Writing was a good way to spread ideas. Everyone from social and religious reformers to nationalist leaders to poets, playwrights and novelists wrote about caste- and gender-based discrimination, colonial oppression and Indian history and culture.

Modern literature in India thus became a tool for social and political change, as well as a way for Indians—including the writers in this section—to explore (and sometimes rediscover) their identities, and the cultures and communities they belonged to.

MULK RAJ ANAND

1905–2004

